



40.3 CROSS OUT THE INCORRECT WORD IN EACH SENTENCE

There was a fall **of** / ~~on~~ more than 13 percent.

- 1 Staff numbers went **for** / **from** 120 to 150.
- 2 **Between** / **To** 15 and 18 percent of stock is unsold.
- 3 We've experienced a boom **of** / **at** 56 percent.
- 4 Profits have fallen **by** / **at** 11 percent.
- 5 The share price peaked **on** / **at** \$22.
- 6 Complaints doubled **in** / **on** the last quarter.
- 7 Our sale was **from** / **between** May and June.



40.4 READ THE REPORT AND ANSWER THE QUESTIONS

Profits have fallen because of the political situation.

True ☒ False ☐ Not given ☐

- 1 Mayvis Homes was established 12 years ago.
True ☐ False ☐ Not given ☐
- 2 Mayvis Homes' share price dropped in the first quarter.
True ☐ False ☐ Not given ☐
- 3 People think Mayvis Homes' share price will climb in the next few months.
True ☐ False ☐ Not given ☐
- 4 Customers do not like the latest houses built by Mayvis Homes.
True ☐ False ☐ Not given ☐
- 5 Last year, there was a sharp rise in Rushington Construction's share price.
True ☐ False ☐ Not given ☐
- 6 Most of Rushington Construction's work comes from the government.
True ☐ False ☐ Not given ☐

INDUSTRY AND TECHNOLOGY

Gloom in construction sector

The construction sector experienced a difficult first quarter, with share prices in the leading construction companies declining considerably. It is believed that worries about recent political events have contributed to a considerable drop in profits in the sector.



Mayvis Homes, which specializes in residential property for the over-60s, saw its share price fall by 12 percent in the first quarter, and there are fears that it could fall further before the end of the year. CEO Stan Gilmore said that customers are adopting a "wait and see" approach before making the decision to buy.

Going against the general trend is Rushington Construction PLC, which focuses on the education and healthcare sectors. Although the company's share price fluctuated slightly last year, the first quarter saw a return to stability, with the company's share price rallying slightly in the first quarter. The company relies on government contracts for between 60 and 85 percent of its work, and therefore is not so affected by short-term market trends.